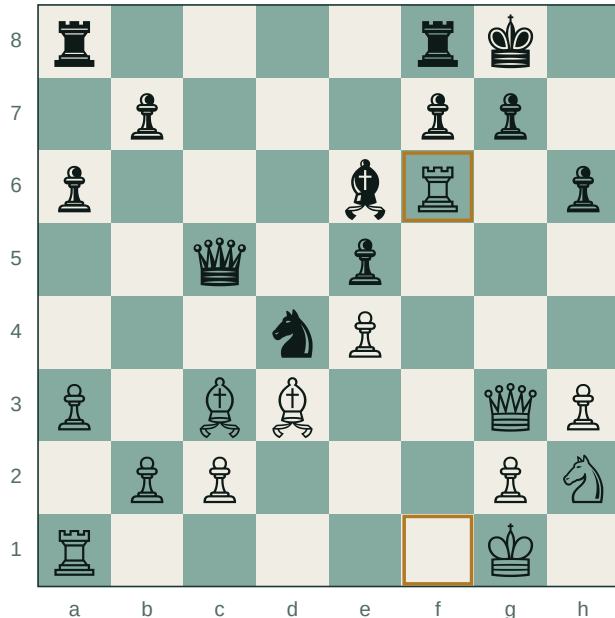


Double checks: Black, move 19

Double checks

Black to move



Previous move: 19.Rxf6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

19...Ne2+ 20. Kf1 Nxg3+

19...Ne2+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From e2 it attacks king on g1, queen on g3 and bishop on c3. Recorded reply: **20.Kf1**.

20...Nxg3+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the queen on g3.

At the end, nominal material is White 25 / Black 31 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +9. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +9:** the balance goes from -3 to +6. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Double check is forcing, but not necessarily winning. The king may escape to safety if the follow-up is missing.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Double check attacks the king with two pieces at once. The defender must move the king, so an ordinary block or capture of just one checker cannot solve the problem.

HOW TO LOOK

Locate the slider that can be uncovered and a checking destination for its blocker. Then calculate the king's legal escapes.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: rook on f6 and queen on g3. Check for tactical protection.